

Thursday, 14 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

TOMORROW · UK OVERVIEW

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Heavy drizzle

12° 7°

BIRMINGHAM

Heavy drizzle

12° 7°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

13° 6°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

13° 6°

Today's top stories

1

Reform councillor suspended for anti-Islam posts.

Ben Rowe is suspended over a series of Islamophobic and antisemitic posts on social media.

UK · NEWS

2

Green Party admits Polanski may have failed to pay council tax.

The Green Party admits that its leader has, until recently, been living on a houseboat in London and may have failed to pay council tax.

UK · NEWS

3

My dad's abuse was uncovered after a burglar stole his laptop and found indecent images.

Lizzie Jones started being abused by her father, David Terrence Pethig, when she was four years old.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Australian musician's US ban prompts apology from girlfriend over Trump post.**
Keli Holiday, one half of electronic duo Peking Duk, was detained at the US-Canada border on Friday.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Our relationship with food is messed up - let's sort it out, says Stanley Tucci.**
The new season of Tucci in Italy sees the actor travel the country finding out why there's a lot more to food than you might think.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Anti-work anthems, Boy George and controversial lyrics: A guide to all 35 Eurovision songs.**
From dancefloor bangers to heartfelt ballads, here are the highlights and low points of Eurovision.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 My mum missed my Glamorgan hat-trick – Norton.**
Glamorgan teenager Tom Norton says his mum Kelly missed his record-breaking efforts during their dramatic County Championship win over Somerset.
SPORT · UK
- 2 'I'm not going anywhere' – furious Real president Perez calls for elections.**
Real Madrid president Florentino Perez stages a tense press conference in which he argues with journalists and calls for elections off the back of a trophyless season.
SPORT · UK
- 3 How do Chelsea rebuild for next season's WSL?.**
Chelsea are in an unusual position with one game to go in the Women's Super League and no silverware on the line.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Watch goals as Dunfermline & Thistle draw play-off semi first leg.**
Watch the goals as Dunfermline Athletic and Partick Thistle draw the first leg of their Scottish Premiership play-off semi-final.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 **The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 2 **Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 3 **Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 4 **Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.
- 5 **Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 6 **Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 7 **Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 44% of us have done THIS while waiting for a kettle to boil. What?
ANSWER: WANDERED OFF AND FORGOTTEN ABOUT IT ENTIRELY.

Q 75% of us check THIS more than ten times a day. What?
ANSWER: THE WEATHER APP.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims our taste in music is 'locked in' by age 14.**
Talk-back: do you still listen to what you loved at 14? And what was on your bedroom wall?
- **What's the most embarrassing thing in your kitchen that you'd hide if guests came round?**
Talk-back: bonus marks for anyone admitting to a Slap Chop or a NutriBullet bought once and never used.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A Yorkshire farmer has won a planning row by getting his prize-winning sheep listed as 'agricultural heritage', preventing a housing development from going ahead next to his field.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Cornish café has started charging customers extra if they ask for the WiFi password before placing their order, claiming it 'improves table turnover by 40%'.

06 — LOTTERY

ESTIMATED · THIS WEEK

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£72 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£72 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

8 TO CHOOSE FROM

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 134 of the year, 231 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Boniface of Tarsus; Christian feast day: Justa, Justina and Henedina; Christian feast day: Maria Domenica Mazzarello; Christian feast day: Matthias the Apostle (Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion, Evangelical Lutheran Church in America). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2001 — Jack Hughes, American hockey player
- 1979 — Dan Auerbach, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1993 — Kristina Mladenovic, French tennis player
- 1943 — Ólafur Ragnar Grímsson, Icelandic academic and politician, 5th President of Iceland
- 1985 — Sam Perrett, New Zealand rugby league player
- 1980 — Júlia Sebestyén, Hungarian figure skater
- 1989 — Rob Gronkowski, American football player
- 1943 — Eddie Low, New Zealand country singer and musician (died 2024)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1955 — Cold War: Eight Communist bloc countries, including the Soviet Union, sign a mutual defense treaty called the Warsaw Pact.
- 1940 — World War II: Rotterdam, Netherlands is bombed by the Luftwaffe of Nazi Germany despite a ceasefire, killing about 900 people and destroying the historic city center.
- 2004 — Crown Prince Frederik of Denmark and Mary Donaldson are married at Copenhagen Cathedral.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1948 — Israel is declared to be an independent state and a provisional government is established. Immediately after the declaration, Israel is attacked by the neighboring Arab states, triggering the 1948 Arab–Israeli War.
- 2004 — Crown Prince Frederik of Denmark and Mary Donaldson are married at Copenhagen Cathedral.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2021 — China successfully lands Zhurong, the country's first Mars rover.
- 1973 — Skylab, the United States' first space station, is launched.

- 2004 — The Constitutional Court of South Korea overturns the impeachment of President Roh Moo-hyun.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 135 of the year, 230 days left in 2026. Today Aoi Matsuri (Kyoto); Army Day (Slovenia); Christian feast day: Achillius of Larissa; Christian feast day: Athanasius of Alexandria (Coptic Church). Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1986 — Adam Moffat, Scottish footballer
- 1987 — Andy Murray, Scottish tennis player
- 1987 — Leonardo Mayer, Argentinian tennis player
- 1985 — Laura Harvey, English football coach
- 1987 — David Adams, American baseball player
- 1985 — Cristiane, Brazilian footballer
- 1987 — Mark Fayne, American ice hockey player
- 1948 — Brian Eno, English singer-songwriter, keyboard player, and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1945 — World War II: The Battle of Poljana, the final skirmish in Europe is fought near Prevalje, Slovenia.
- 1940 — USS Sailfish is recommissioned. It was originally the USS Squalus.
- 2023 — The UN commemorates the Palestinian Nakba Day for the first time.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1970 — President Richard Nixon appoints Anna Mae Hays and Elizabeth P. Hoisington the first female United States Army generals.
- 1991 — Édith Cresson becomes France's first female Prime Minister.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final

JUNE 2026	
THU 4	NBA Finals begin
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)